

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Chicago leaders prepare for ‘TIF cliff’

Mayor to repay \$1.25B with funds from expired taxing districts, but plan has risks

By **A.D. Quig**
Chicago Tribune

One of Mayor Brandon Johnson’s signature projects is an ambitious plan to spend \$1.25 billion over five years

to build affordable housing, rehab or construct new commercial buildings and issue small business loans across Chicago. Helping fund the progressive program is a seemingly

unremarkable fiscal detail: The money borrowed for the work will be paid back with property tax dollars being freed up across the city as controversial tax increment financing districts, or TIFs, begin to expire. While the Johnson administration notes the move would not require

the city to hike property taxes and insists there will be plenty to pay back the borrowed money plus interest, the move could have several, sometimes divergent, consequences. Binding so much cash to debt payments could hamstring city finances. And aldermen who have banked

on their local TIF funds to pay for projects in their wards for the last quarter century might instead have to get in line behind their colleagues. But on the other side of the ledger, Chicago schools, parks and other government bodies that have gone decades without being able to count on new

tax dollars tied to construction or fresh development in certain TIF districts will soon be able to. It’s the latest chapter in Chicago’s long history with TIFs, which supporters have praised for spurring growth in struggling neighborhoods

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BEARS 24, PACKERS 22



ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

KICKING AND SCREAMING

Bears kicker Cairo Santos celebrates after kicking the game-winning field goal Sunday against the Packers at Lambeau Field in Green Bay, Wisconsin. The Bears broke a 10-game losing streak this season, and an 11-game losing streak in their rivalry with the Packers. It was their first win in Green Bay since 2015. **Chicago Sports**

INSIDE



MANUEL BALCE CENETA/AP

Lawmakers brace for Trump’s Jan. 6 pardons

The anniversary of the Jan. 6, 2021, attack on the Capitol has a new focus as lawmakers brace for the prospect that President-elect Donald Trump may soon pardon many of the more than 1,500 people charged for their actions related to the riot. **Nation & World**

Chicago ranks among worst for traffic

The area’s drivers lost an average of 102 hours to delays last year, on par with New York City, an annual report says. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Bill Murray’s blues concert no joke

Murray and his band gave a satisfying show Friday in Pilsen. That he doesn’t have a singing voice was beside the point. **Arts & Living**

Blackhawks can’t stop Rangers

Connor Bedard extended his point streak to seven games, but the Hawks lost 6-2 on Sunday in Chicago. **Chicago Sports**

Parts of central US hit with dangerous cold, snow, wind

Forecasts say harsh winter conditions to spread eastward

By **Patrick Whittle and Brian Witte**
Associated Press

A blast of snow, ice, wind and plunging temperatures stirred up dangerous travel conditions in parts of the central U.S. on Sunday as a disruptive winter storm brought the possibility of the “heaviest snowfall in a decade” to some areas. Forecasts are calling for harsh winter conditions

to spread eastward in the coming days. Snow and ice blanketed major roads in nearly all of Kansas, western Nebraska and parts of Indiana, where the state’s National Guard was activated to help any motorists who were stuck. At least 8 inches of snow were expected, particularly north of Interstate 70, as the National Weather Service issued winter storm warnings for Kansas

and Missouri, where blizzard conditions brought wind gusts of up to 45 mph. The warning extended to New Jersey for Monday and into early Tuesday. “For locations in this region that receive the highest snow totals, it may be the heaviest snowfall in at least a decade,” the agency said early Sunday. About 63 million people

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All police in state now must wear cameras, but compliance unclear

Small departments were allowed extra time to buy gear

By **Olivia Olander and Jeremy Gorner**
Chicago Tribune

Under one of the few significant mandates of the controversial 2021 SAFE-T Act that was backed by both

advocates for police reform and law enforcement, every police officer in Illinois as of New Year’s Day is required to wear a body camera while on duty. Police departments are required to report their use of bodycams, but whether all of the state’s roughly 1,000 law enforcement agencies were in compliance with the law, which

gave smaller departments and state agencies more time to get equipped with the technology, remained unclear at the Jan. 1 deadline. The most recent report from the Illinois Law Enforcement Training and Standards Board is from 2023, before many small

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